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一、文章主旨

中文主旨

本文讲述了作者辞去全职工作后，从狂热追求“拥有一切”的生活哲学转变为拥抱“放慢生活节奏”的亲身经历，并对分析了英美两国出现“放慢生活节奏”这一社会趋势的不同根源，最终指出这种简单的生活方式所带来的精神回报，远远超过了经济成功和社会地位。

英文主旨

This article describes the author's personal experience of transforming from a passionate advocate of the philosophy of "having it all" to embracing "downshifting" after quitting her full-time job. It compares and analyzes the different roots of the social trend of downshifting in Britain and America, and finally points out that the spiritual rewards brought by this simple lifestyle far outweigh financial success and social status.

二、逐句翻译与考点解析

第一段

1. **原文**: When I decided to quit my full time employment it never occurred to me that I might become a part of a new international trend.

翻译: 当我决定辞去全职工作时，我从未想到自己会成为一种新的国际潮流的一部分。

常考词汇/短语:

- quit /kwɪt/ v. 辞职; 放弃; 停止
- full time employment 全职工作
- it never occurred to sb that... 某人从未想到..... (高频句型)
- trend /trend/ n. 趋势, 潮流; 倾向

2. **原文**: A lateral move that hurt my pride and blocked my professional progress prompted me to abandon my relatively high profile career although, in the manner of a disgraced government minister, I covered my exit by claiming "I wanted to spend more time with my family".

翻译: 一次伤了我自尊、阻碍了我职业发展的平级调动促使我放弃了那份相对引人注目的职业。不过，我以一位失势政府部长的方式，声称“我想多陪陪家人”来掩饰自己的离职。

常考词汇/短语:

- lateral /'lætərəl/ adj. 侧面的; 横向的; 平级的
- lateral move 平级调动
- block /blɒk/ v. 阻碍, 堵塞; 阻挡 n. 街区; 块
- professional progress 职业发展
- prompt /prɒmpt/ v. 促使, 推动; 提示 adj. 迅速的, 及时的
- abandon /ə'bændən/ v. 放弃, 抛弃
- relatively /'relatɪvli/ adv. 相对地, 比较地
- high profile 高姿态的; 引人注目的
- in the manner of 以.....的方式
- disgraced /dɪs'greɪst/ adj. 失势的; 丢脸的
- cover /'kʌvə(r)/ v. 掩饰, 掩盖; 覆盖; 报道
- exit /'eksɪt/ n. 离开, 退出; 出口 v. 离开
- claim /kleɪm/ v. 声称, 宣称; 要求; 索赔

长难句分析:

这是一个包含定语从句和让步状语从句的复合句。

- 主句: A lateral move prompted me to abandon my relatively high profile career

- 定语从句: **that hurt my pride and blocked my professional progress** 修饰先行词 **A lateral move**
- 让步状语从句: **although I covered my exit by claiming "I wanted to spend more time with my family"**
- 插入的方式状语: **in the manner of a disgraced government minister**

本段段意: 作者交代了自己辞去全职工作的直接导火索——一次伤害自尊的平级调动, 以及她用“想多陪伴家人”这个借口来掩饰真实离职原因的经历。

第二段

1. **原文:** Curiously, some two-and-a-half years and two novels later, my experiment in what the Americans term "downshifting" has turned my tired excuse into an absolute reality.

翻译: 奇怪的是, 大约两年半后, 在我写完两部小说之后, 我这种被美国人称为“放慢生活节奏”的尝试, 已经把我那老掉牙的借口变成了绝对的现实。

常考词汇/短语:

- curiously /'kjʊəriəsli/ adv. 奇怪地; 好奇地
- term /tɜ:m/ v. 把.....称为, 把.....叫做 n. 学期; 术语; 期限
- downshifting /'daʊnʃɪftɪŋ/ n. 放慢生活节奏; (汽车) 减挡
- experiment /ɪk'sperɪmənt/ n. 尝试; 实验 v. 做实验
- tired /'taɪəd/ adj. 陈旧的, 老掉牙的; 疲惫的
- excuse /ɪk'skju:s/ n. 借口, 理由 v. 原谅
- absolute /'æbsəlu:t/ adj. 绝对的; 完全的
- reality /ri'æləti/ n. 现实; 实际情况

2. **原文:** I have been transformed from a passionate advocate of the philosophy of "having it all", preached by Linda Kelsey for the past seven years in the pages of She magazine, into a woman who is happy to settle for a bit of everything.

翻译: 我已经从一个狂热倡导“拥有一切”生活哲学的人, 变成了一个乐于对一切都浅尝辄止的女人。而“拥有一切”的哲学是琳达·凯尔西过去七年在《她》杂志上一直宣扬的。

常考词汇/短语:

- transform /træns'fɔ:m/ v. 使改变形态; 使转变, 使改观
- passionate /'pæʃənət/ adj. 热情的; 狂热的; 激昂的
- advocate /'ædvəkət/ n. 倡导者, 拥护者 v. 提倡, 拥护
- philosophy /fə'lɒsəfi/ n. 哲学; 生活哲学, 人生观
- preach /pri:tʃ/ v. 宣扬, 鼓吹; 布道, 讲道
- settle for 勉强接受, 将就
- a bit of everything 什么都来一点, 浅尝辄止

长难句分析:

这是一个包含多个定语成分的复合句。

- 主句: **I have been transformed from a passionate advocate into a woman**
- 介词短语定语: **of the philosophy of "having it all"** 修饰 **advocate**
- 过去分词短语定语: **preached by Linda Kelsey for the past seven years in the pages of She magazine** 修饰 **the philosophy of "having it all"**
- 定语从句: **who is happy to settle for a bit of everything** 修饰先行词 **a woman**

本段段意: 作者讲述了两年半时间里自己生活发生的彻底转变, 当初用来掩饰离职的借口, 如今已经变成了她真实的生活状态, 她从“拥有一切”的信徒变成了“放慢生活节奏”的践行者。

第三段

1. **原文**: I have discovered, as perhaps Kelsey will after her much-publicized resignation from the editorship of She after a build-up of stress, that abandoning the doctrine of "juggling your life", and making the alternative move into "downshifting" brings with it far greater rewards than financial success and social status.

翻译: 我发现, 放弃“为生活奔波”的信条, 转而选择“放慢生活节奏”, 所带来的回报远比经济成功和社会地位要丰厚得多。或许凯尔西在因压力过大而高调辞去《她》杂志主编一职后也会有同样的发现。

常考词汇/短语:

- much-publicized /ˌmʌtʃ ˈpʌblɪsaɪzd/ adj. 广为宣传的; 高调的
- resignation /ˌrezɪɡˈneɪʃn/ n. 辞职; 辞职信; 顺从
- editorship /ˈedɪtəʃɪp/ n. 编辑职位; 主编身份
- build-up /ˈbɪld ʌp/ n. 逐渐积累; 逐步增强
- stress /stres/ n. 压力; 强调; 紧张 v. 强调; 使紧张
- doctrine /ˈdɒktrɪn/ n. 信条, 教义; 学说
- juggle /ˈdʒʌɡl/ v. 尽力同时应付 (多项工作或活动); 玩杂耍
- alternative /ɔːlˈtɜːnətɪv/ adj. 可供选择的; 替代的 n. 选择
- reward /rɪˈwɔːd/ n. 回报; 报酬; 奖赏 v. 奖励, 奖赏
- financial success 经济成功
- social status 社会地位

长难句分析:

这是一个包含方式状语从句和宾语从句的复合句。

- 主句: I have discovered that...
 - 方式状语从句: as perhaps kelsey will after her much-publicized resignation... (从句中省略了与主句相同的谓语 discover)
 - 宾语从句: that abandoning... and making... brings with it far greater rewards...
 - 宾语从句主语: abandoning the doctrine of "juggling your life", and making the alternative move into "downshifting" (两个动名词短语并列)
 - 宾语从句谓语: brings
 - 宾语从句宾语: far greater rewards than financial success and social status
 - 状语: with it (it 指代前面的“放慢生活节奏”这一选择)
2. **原文**: Nothing could persuade me to return to the kind of life Kelsey used to advocate and I once enjoyed: 12-hour working days, pressured deadlines, the fearful strain of office politics and the limitations of being a parent on "quality time".
- 翻译**: 没有什么能说服我回到凯尔西过去倡导、我也曾享受过的那种生活: 每天12小时的工作时间、令人倍感压力的最后期限、办公室政治带来的可怕压力, 以及作为父母只能在“黄金时间”陪伴孩子的局限。
- 常考词汇/短语**:
- persuade /pəˈsweɪd/ v. 说服, 劝说
 - return to 回到; 恢复
 - used to do sth 过去常常做某事
 - pressured /ˈpreʃəd/ adj. 有压力的; 受压的
 - deadline /ˈdedlaɪn/ n. 最后期限, 截止日期
 - fearful /ˈfeəfl/ adj. 可怕的; 担心的
 - strain /streɪn/ n. 压力; 紧张; 拉力 v. 拉紧; 使紧张
 - office politics 办公室政治
 - limitation /ˌlɪmɪˈteɪʃn/ n. 局限; 限制

- quality time 黄金时间（指与家人共度的珍贵时光）

长难句分析：

这是一个包含定语从句和同位语的复合句。

- 主句：Nothing could persuade me to return to the kind of life
- 定语从句：Kelsey used to advocate and I once enjoyed 修饰先行词 the kind of life（省略了关系代词 that/which）
- 同位语：冒号后面的四个名词短语，具体解释说明“那种生活”的内容

本段段意：作者表达了对“放慢生活节奏”这种生活方式的坚定认可，认为它带来的精神回报远超物质和地位，并且明确表示再也不愿回到过去那种高压、忙碌、牺牲家庭时间的生活。

第四段

1. **原文：**In America, the move away from juggling to a simpler, less materialistic lifestyle is a well-established trend.

翻译：在美国，从为生活奔波转向更简单、更少物质主义的生活方式已经成为一种根深蒂固的趋势。

常考词汇/短语：

- move away from 从.....离开；摆脱
- materialistic /məˈtɪəriəˈlɪstɪk/ adj. 物质主义的；唯物主义的
- lifestyle /ˈlaɪfstɑɪl/ n. 生活方式
- well-established /ˌwel ɪˈstæblɪʃt/ adj. 根深蒂固的；确立已久的；公认的

2. **原文：**Downshifting-also known in America as "voluntary simplicity"-has, ironically, even bred a new area of what might be termed anticonsumerism.

翻译：具有讽刺意味的是，放慢生活节奏——在美国也被称为“自愿简朴”——甚至催生了一个可以被称为反消费主义的新领域。

常考词汇/短语：

- voluntary /ˈvɒləntəri/ adj. 自愿的；志愿的
- simplicity /sɪmˈplɪsəti/ n. 简单；简朴；朴素
- ironically /aɪˈrɒnɪkli/ adv. 具有讽刺意味的是；讽刺地
- breed /briːd/ v. 滋生；催生；繁殖；养育 n. 品种；种类
- anticonsumerism /ˌæntɪkənˈsjʊːməɪzəm/ n. 反消费主义

3. **原文：**There are a number of bestselling downshifting self-help books for people who want to simplify their lives; there are newsletters, such as The Tightwad Gazette, that give hundreds of thousands of Americans useful tips on anything from recycling their cling-film to making their own soap; there are even support groups for those who want to achieve the mid-'90s equivalent of dropping out.

翻译：有许多关于放慢生活节奏的畅销自助书籍，供那些想要简化生活的人阅读；还有像《吝啬鬼公报》这样的通讯刊物，给数十万美国人提供各种实用建议，从回收保鲜膜到自制肥皂；甚至还有一些互助小组，帮助那些想要实现90年代中期那种“遁世”生活的人。

常考词汇/短语：

- a number of 许多，大量
- bestselling /ˌbestˈselɪŋ/ adj. 畅销的
- self-help /ˌselfˈhelp/ adj. 自助的；自救的 n. 自助
- simplify /ˈsɪmplɪfaɪ/ v. 简化；使简易
- newsletter /ˈnjuːzletə(r)/ n. 通讯；时事通讯
- hundreds of thousands of 数十万的
- tip /tɪp/ n. 建议，窍门；小费；尖端 v. 给小费；倾斜
- recycle /ˌriːˈsaɪkl/ v. 回收利用；再利用
- cling-film /ˈklɪŋ fɪlm/ n. 保鲜膜
- support group 互助小组
- equivalent /ɪˈkwɪvələnt/ n. 对等物；等价物 adj. 等价的；相等的
- drop out 退出；退学；遁世，脱离传统社会

长难句分析：

这是一个由三个分号连接的并列句，三个分句均为 **there be** 句型。

- 分句1: **There are a number of bestselling downshifting self-help books for people who want to simplify their lives** (含定语从句修饰 **people**)
- 分句2: **there are newsletters... that give hundreds of thousands of Americans useful tips...** (含插入语举例和定语从句修饰 **newsletters**)
- 分句3: **there are even support groups for those who want to achieve the mid-'90s equivalent of dropping out** (含定语从句修饰 **those**)

本段段意：介绍了美国“放慢生活节奏”趋势的发展现状，指出它已经成为一种根深蒂固的社会现象，并且衍生出了反消费主义文化以及相关的书籍、刊物和互助组织。

第五段

1. **原文：**While in America the trend started as a reaction to the economic decline after the mass redundancies caused by downsizing in the late '80s—and is still linked to the politics of thrift, in Britain, at least among the middle-class downshiftingers of my acquaintance, we have different reasons for seeking to simplify our lives.

翻译：在美国，这一趋势最初是对80年代末企业裁员导致大规模失业后的经济衰退的一种反应，并且至今仍与节俭政治相关；而在英国，至少在我认识的中产阶级放慢生活节奏者当中，我们寻求简化生活的原因却有所不同。

常考词汇/短语：

- while /waɪl/ conj. 而，然而（表对比）；当.....的时候；虽然
- reaction /ri'ækʃn/ n. 反应；回应；反作用
- economic decline 经济衰退
- mass /mæs/ adj. 大规模的；大量的 n. 大量；群众
- redundancy /rɪ'dʌndənsi/ n. 裁员；冗余；多余
- cause /kɔːz/ v. 导致，引起 n. 原因；事业
- downsizing /'daʊnsaɪzɪŋ/ n. (企业) 裁员，精简规模
- link to 与.....相关联；连接到
- politics of thrift 节俭政治
- middle-class /,mɪdl 'klɑːs/ adj. 中产阶级的
- downshifter /'daʊnʃɪftə(r)/ n. 放慢生活节奏的人
- acquaintance /ə'kweɪntəns/ n. 相识的人；熟人；了解
- seek to do sth 试图做某事；寻求做某事

长难句分析：

这是一个由 **while** 连接的并列复合句，**while** 在此处表示对比关系。

- 前一分句: **in America the trend started as a reaction to the economic decline... and is still linked to the politics of thrift**
 - 时间状语: **after the mass redundancies caused by downsizing in the late '80s**
 - 过去分词定语: **caused by downsizing in the late '80s** 修饰 **mass redundancies**
- 后一分句: **in Britain... we have different reasons for seeking to simplify our lives**
 - 插入语: **at least among the middle-class downshiftingers of my acquaintance**

本段段意：对比了英美两国“放慢生活节奏”趋势产生的不同背景和原因，美国的这一趋势源于经济衰退和节俭政治，而英国的原因则与此不同。

第六段

1. **原文:** For the women of my generation who were urged to keep juggling through the '80s, downshifting in the mid-'90s is not so much a search for the mythical good life—growing your own organic vegetables, and risking turning into one—as a personal recognition of your limitations.

翻译: 对于我们这一代在80年代被敦促要不断为生活奔波的女性来说，90年代中期的放慢生活节奏，与其说是在寻找那种神话般的美好生活——自己种有机蔬菜，甚至冒着变成“有机蔬菜”的风险——不如说是对自身局限性的一种个人认知。

常考词汇/短语:

- generation /ˌdʒenə'reɪʃn/ n. 一代；一代人；产生
- urge /ɜːdʒ/ v. 敦促，催促；力劝 n. 强烈的欲望
- not so much...as... 与其说.....不如说..... (高频考点句型)
- search for 寻找；搜寻
- mythical /'mɪθɪkl/ adj. 神话般的；虚构的；想象的
- organic /ɔː'ɡænɪk/ adj. 有机的；绿色的；器官的
- risk /rɪsk/ v. 冒.....的风险；冒险做 n. 风险；危险
- turn into 变成；成为
- recognition /ˌrekəɡ'nɪʃn/ n. 认识；认可；承认

长难句分析:

这是一个包含定语从句、插入语和固定句型的复合句。

- 主句: downshifting in the mid-'90s is not so much a search for the mythical good life as a personal recognition of your limitations
- 介词短语状语: For the women of my generation who were urged to keep juggling through the '80s (含定语从句修饰 the women of my generation)
- 插入语: growing your own organic vegetables, and risking turning into one (举例说明“神话般的美好生活”)
- 核心句型: not so much A as B (与其说A, 不如说B)

本段段意: 作者揭示了英国中产阶级女性选择“放慢生活节奏”的真正原因——不是为了追求不切实际的田园美好生活，而是在经历了80年代的高压生活后，终于认识到了自身能力的局限性。

三、完整原文

Text 5

When I decided to quit my full time employment it never occurred to me that I might become a part of a new international trend. A lateral move that hurt my pride and blocked my professional progress prompted me to abandon my relatively high profile career although, in the manner of a disgraced government minister, I covered my exit by claiming "I wanted to spend more time with my family".

Curiously, some two-and-a-half years and two novels later, my experiment in what the Americans term "downshifting" has turned my tired excuse into an absolute reality. I have been transformed from a passionate advocate of the philosophy of "having it all", preached by Linda Kelsey for the past seven years in the pages of She magazine, into a woman who is happy to settle for a bit of everything.

I have discovered, as perhaps Kelsey will after her much-publicized resignation from the editorship of She after a build-up of stress, that abandoning the doctrine of "juggling your life", and making the alternative move into "downshifting" brings with it far greater rewards than financial success and social status. Nothing could persuade me to return to the kind of life Kelsey used to advocate and I once enjoyed: 12-hour working days, pressured deadlines, the fearful strain of office politics and the limitations of being a parent on "quality time".

In America, the move away from juggling to a simpler, less materialistic lifestyle is a well-established trend. Downshifting—also known in America as "voluntary simplicity"—has, ironically, even bred a new area of what might be termed anticonsumerism. There are a number of bestselling downshifting self-help books for people who want to simplify their lives; there are newsletters, such as The Tightwad Gazette, that give hundreds of thousands of Americans useful tips on anything from recycling their cling-film to making their own soap; there are even support groups for those who want to achieve the mid-'90s equivalent of dropping out.

While in America the trend started as a reaction to the economic decline after the mass redundancies caused by downsizing in the late '80s—and is still linked to the politics of thrift, in Britain, at least among the middle-class downshifters of my acquaintance, we have different reasons for seeking to simplify our lives.

For the women of my generation who were urged to keep juggling through the '80s, downshifting in the mid-'90s is not so much a search for the mythical good life—growing your own organic vegetables, and risking turning into one—as a personal recognition of your limitations.

四、完整译文

Text 5 译文

当我决定辞去全职工作时，我从未想到自己会成为一种新的国际潮流的一部分。一次伤了我自尊、阻碍了我职业发展的平级调动促使我放弃了那份相对引人注目的职业。不过，我以一位失势政府部长的方式，声称“我想多陪陪家人”来掩饰自己的离职。

奇怪的是，大约两年半后，在我写完两部小说之后，我这种被美国人称为“放慢生活节奏”的尝试，已经把我那老掉牙的借口变成了绝对的现实。我已经从一个狂热倡导“拥有一切”生活哲学的人，变成了一个乐于对一切都浅尝辄止的女人。而“拥有一切”的哲学是琳达·凯尔西过去七年在《她》杂志上一直宣扬的。

我发现，放弃“为生活奔波”的信条，转而选择“放慢生活节奏”，所带来的回报远比经济成功和社会地位要丰厚得多。或许凯尔西在因压力过大而高调辞去《她》杂志主编一职后也会有同样的发现。没有什么能说服我回到凯尔西过去倡导、我也曾享受过的那种生活：每天12小时的工作时间、令人倍感压力的最后期限、办公室政治带来的可怕压力，以及作为父母只能在“黄金时间”陪伴孩子的局限。

在美国，从为生活奔波转向更简单、更少物质主义的生活方式已经成为一种根深蒂固的趋势。具有讽刺意味的是，放慢生活节奏——在美国也被称为“自愿简朴”——甚至催生了一个可以被称作反消费主义的新领域。有许多关于放慢生活节奏的畅销自助书籍，供那些想要简化生活的人阅读；还有像《吝啬鬼公报》这样的通讯刊物，给数十万美国人提供各种实用建议，从回收保鲜膜到自制肥皂；甚至还有一些互助小组，帮助那些想要实现90年代中期那种“遁世”生活的人。

在美国，这一趋势最初是对80年代末企业裁员导致大规模失业后的经济衰退的一种反应，并且至今仍与节俭政治相关；而在英国，至少在我认识的中产阶级放慢生活节奏者当中，我们寻求简化生活的原因却有所不同。

对于我们这一代在80年代被敦促要不断为生活奔波的女性来说，90年代中期的放慢生活节奏，与其说是在寻找那种神话般的美好生活——自己种有机蔬菜，甚至冒着变成“有机蔬菜”的风险——不如说是对自身局限性的一种个人认知。